# Managing a Referral

*Quick reference for reading and updating a referral: Aetna case managers*

How to read a referral, keep it up to date, and, for Recovery at Home, record the discharge date.

## 1 Read the referral

- On the member page, select the benefit tile, then the **arrow** at the end of a referral's row to expand it.
- **Status** shows where the referral is. **Service Provider** shows who is assigned. Once the status is **Accepted By Provider**, the provider's contact information can be shared with the member.
- **Encounter Summary** shows hours Allowed, Used, and Remaining. **Key Dates** shows when the referral was received, assigned, and accepted. **Encounters** lists each completed visit.

| Status | What it means |
|---|---|
| **New** | Referral has been created and is awaiting approval. |
| **Approved** | The system recognizes the referral but it hasn't been assigned to a local provider yet. |
| **Assigned to Provider** | A provider was found in the service area and alerted (they have 3 days to respond). |
| **Accepted By Provider** | The provider has accepted. Contact info can be shared with the member. |
| **Unable to Contact** | The provider couldn't reach the member after 3 attempts. |
| **Member Declined Services** | The member declined the provider that reached out. |
| **Completed** | All rate types have been invoiced and billed for the service. |
| **Closed** | The service was refunded and the referral is now inactive. |
| **On Hold** | Personal Care is paused while Recovery at Home is open, and resumes when it ends. |
| **Eligibility Failed** | The referral was closed. On a readmission, Benefits Hub closes the old Post-Discharge or Recovery at Home referral this way when you submit the new one, and its unused hours expire. |

## 2 Keep it up to date

| What | How | Good to know |
|---|---|---|
| **Referral narrative** | Select the pencil next to **Referral Narrative**, edit, and **Save**. | You can write and edit it, up to 250 characters. The first line pointing providers to the Service Detail Questions is added for you. |
| **Add a note** | **Add > Add Note**. Choose a **Note Type** (required), write the note, and select **Save Note**. | **Adding a note does not alert The Helper Bees.** If something needs action, submit a Zendesk ticket. |
| **Add a document** | **Add > Add Document**, then **Upload**. | Use it for proof of POA or TPA, a discharge summary, or authorization paperwork. Documents are visible to the THB coordinator. |
| **See what was added** | **View > View Notes**, **View Documents**, or **View SDQ**. | View SDQ shows the answers submitted with the referral. |
| **Share the status** | **View > Copy Tracking Link**. | Members and families can open the link without logging in. |
| **Member email** | In the Overview, select the pencil next to **Email**, type the address, and select the check mark. | You can add or correct a member's email. |

**Note types:** Visit Scheduled Within 1 Week, 2 Weeks, or 1 Month; Member Outreach in Progress (Contact Attempts); Member Declined Services; Unable to Contact Member; Unable to Staff; Provider Outreach (Sent Email, Left Message, or Sent Text); Member Request to Delay Services; Status Change; General; Escalation.

## 3 Record the discharge date (Recovery at Home only)

- Expand the referral and select **Add > Discharge date**. The **Record** link under Key Dates opens the same box.
- Enter the date the member was **discharged to home**. Before you save, the box shows how the expiration will change.
- Until a date is recorded, the referral expires **30 days after submission**, never later than 12/31. After it is recorded, it expires **30 days after the discharge date** (day one is the day after discharge). **Date Discharged** then appears under Key Dates.
- Benefits Hub **blocks** a future date, and a date that would make the referral already expired. For the second, it tells you to **contact THB**.
- It **warns** you if a date moves the expiration earlier. Save only if the member was discharged before the referral was created.
- **Discharge date** stays in the Add menu, so you can correct the date later.

**KEY TAKEAWAY**

Read the status and Key Dates first, record what happened in a note or the narrative, and use a Zendesk ticket when something needs action. Notes do not alert The Helper Bees.